Verbal reasoning: starter worked answers

12 original questions: three each on letter codes, word analogies, classifications and constant-step sequences.

For families preparing for tests taken in 2027. This selected-skill set is not an official past paper or a complete verbal-reasoning syllabus.

Start untimed. Check the relationship or rule as well as the answer. The option letters match the separate question booklet.

Find both booklets, methods and online practice at www.11plusexampapers.com/papers

Letter codes

1. A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z. In this code every letter moves the same number of places forwards; the alphabet wraps after Z or before A. BAG becomes DCI. What does HEN become?

Answer: D - JGP

The rule moves every letter 2 places forwards. Check BAG → DCI, then apply it to the target: H → J, E → G, N → P. Put the letters in their original order: JGP. The coded result need not be a real word.

2. A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z. In this code every letter moves the same number of places backwards; the alphabet wraps after Z or before A. BAG becomes AZF. What does JAR become?

Answer: C - IZQ

The rule moves every letter 1 place backwards. Check BAG → AZF, then apply it to the target: J → I, A → Z, R → Q. Put the letters in their original order: IZQ. The coded result need not be a real word.

3. A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z. In this code every letter moves the same number of places forwards; the alphabet wraps after Z or before A. BAG becomes EDJ. What does ZIP become?

Answer: B - CLS

The rule moves every letter 3 places forwards. Check BAG → EDJ, then apply it to the target: Z → C, I → L, P → S. Put the letters in their original order: CLS. The coded result need not be a real word.

Word analogies

4. Cat is to kitten as dog is to ___?

Answer: A - puppy

A kitten is a baby cat; a puppy is a baby dog.

5. Hot is to cold as fast is to ___?

Answer: B - slow

Hot and cold are opposites; fast and slow are opposites.

6. Finger is to hand as toe is to ___?

Answer: A - foot

Fingers are part of a hand; toes are part of a foot.

Word classifications

7. Three options are colour names. Which option is outside that stated group?

Answer: A - spoon

Red, blue and green name colours. Spoon names an item of cutlery.

8. Three options are days of the week. Which option is outside that stated group?

Answer: D - winter

Monday, Thursday and Sunday are days. Winter is a season.

9. Three options are months. Which option is outside that stated group?

Answer: C - Friday

January, April and October are months. Friday is a day of the week.

Constant-step sequences

10. Continue the constant-step number sequence: 7, 10, 13, 16, ?

Answer: C - 19

The gap is +3 each time: 10 - 7 = 3, 13 - 10 = 3, and 16 - 13 = 3. Add the same gap once more: 16 + 3 = 19.

11. Continue the constant-step number sequence: 18, 22, 26, 30, ?

Answer: B - 34

The gap is +4 each time: 22 - 18 = 4, 26 - 22 = 4, and 30 - 26 = 4. Add the same gap once more: 30 + 4 = 34.

12. A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z. Continue this constant-step forward letter sequence without wrapping: A, C, E, G, ?

Answer: A - I

Move forwards 2 alphabet places at every step. A (1), C (3), E (5), G (7) have positions separated by 2. The next position is 9, which is I.

Next step: review a missed skill at www.11plusexampapers.com/subjects/verbal-reasoning. Original questions and explanations © 2026 11 Plus Exam Papers.